

Using the Automasonry Python Script in Blender

The Automasonry Python script extends Blender's functionality to make creation of buildings easy, comparable to what is done in commercial software like 3DS Max or AutoCAD. Let's use it to make a castle.

The term 'automasonry' applies to creating anything related to the construction of houses and buildings. However, this script makes a particular job easier for us—the creation of virtual sets for animations with Maya, Blender or any other animation software. This script becomes more significant when you want virtual sets with an ancient or medieval appearance.

Basically, this script creates straight walls that can be fine-tuned to look like what you want. Different variables can be set to create a variety of walls, as required. The wall, once created, has no limitations; it could be set to follow a curved object or path. Various combinations of settings could be used to create differing effects and illusions that a particular setting might require. Castles, towers and other ancient buildings could be easily created using this script, which could also be used to create sets for games.

Getting started

Download the script from:

<http://bit.ly/LUeVnU>

Copy the downloaded script to the Blender default *scripts* folder. On starting Blender, you can run the script from the *Scripts/Wizards* menu; the script displays a default GUI with the various parameters represented in sliders, numeric inputs and buttons. The *Make this wall!* button creates the mesh, and the *Exit* button exits the script. The *WALL* inputs let you change the length of the wall (*Wall Width*), its height (*Wall Height*), and select straight (*Straight Edges*) or offset edges. The *STONES* inputs let you change the X axis scale (*Width*),

the Y axis scale (*Depth*), the Z axis scale (*Height*), the *bevel* on the stones' edges (*Bevel*), the width and depth for the grout (*Grout W/D*), the stone's height/width symmetry (*Row Width*), etc. Other options include adding doors (you can specify whether to angle door edges, the door's size and its position along the mesh), windows (the new input is *Spacing* for the window array), and crenels.

Creating the default wall

To create your first default wall, simply invoke *Add > Mesh > Masonry > Wall*. With a few intelligent tweaks here and there, it is easy to make a castle wall in Blender, thanks to the creator of this wonderful script. You could modify the walls using built-in Blender functions—however, once you have completed the wall, you cannot return to the properties. Completion, in this case, means changing mode, or adding another object to modify the look of the wall. Figure1 shows you the first wall created with the default parameters of the script.

Creating a tower

Once you are comfortable creating the default wall, having practised it over and over again, you will reach the task of creating a circular tower for your castle. You will be initially surprised to learn that your tower can come to life just by fine-tuning the default wall and setting it up in combination with another element that will modify it quite drastically. For this, first create a Bezier circle in the top viewport (press numeric 7 to go to the top viewport). While the circle is still

